

Frontech Palm DV

Picture happy

Frontech has brought integration and compactness to the fore with the Palm DV. This digital camcorder can also be used as a digital camera, a Web cam, a voice recorder and an external storage device. It comes bundled with a small tripod, a quick start guide, a manual, an A/V cable, a USB cable, a sling and batteries. The driver CD has the palm DV manager, Ulead Photo Express/Explorer, VideoLive Mail, Windows Netmeeting and DVD Movie Factory.

The camera has a 1.4-inch LCD display for easy management. It is easy to operate—using the quick start guide—and the manual explains every function well. The PalmDV can be set to operate on different resolutions: VGA, 1.3 megapixels or 2 megapixels. It has 16



MB SDRAM integrated, and can store a maximum of 10 still pictures or 90 seconds of video (at 2 megapixels and high quality), and up to 20 minutes of voice recording.

Still images are stored in the JPEG format (ranging from a resolution of 640 x 480 to 1600 x 1200, interpolated); video is stored in the AVI format (at 15 to 25 fps) and voice is stored in the WAV format.

The Palm DV performed satisfactorily in the tests, with no outstanding aspect to it. One might fumble with deleting pictures or exiting from the playback mode, as it is not explained in the manual. The menu scroll bar is sluggish and refuses to scroll up and down at times. When used as a removable disk, Windows only detected 6 MB of space, this is unexplained in the manual.

Price: Rs 11,000
Contact: Jupiter Infosys India Ltd
Phone: 022-22001211
Fax: 022-22001214
E-mail: frontech@bom5.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.frontechonline.com

Another setback is the lack of a zoom utility, especially during video recording. The bundled tripod was cumbersome to attach, and when we finally managed, we were left with a camera that tilted to one side.

The price is right, it also supports 2 megapixels on the box, although the manual could use an improvement. It is still a good buy for its price, compactness and features.

SPECIFICATIONS

Tripod stand, camera to TV audio/video cable, installation guide, driver + software CD, quick start guide, neck strap, two AA size batteries

Frontech Palm DV		B+
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶	



വിശ്വസിക്കാനേ
കഴിയില്ല

read on page 58-59